

align himself at times with revolutionaries, at other times with monarchists—in 1797, for example, he wrote a funeral cantata honoring a revolutionary hero, only to rework it in 1820 to honor a royalist. Cherubini would have been witness to major historical events such as the storming of the Bastille, the execution of Louis XVI, and the rise of Napoleon (with whom he had a rocky relationship). The return of monarchical rule in 1814 made his life considerably easier.



EXECUTION OF LOUIS XVI OF FRANCE IN
JANUARY 1793